

UNIT 1: ARTS AND HOLIDAYING

Chapter 9: The Winter's Tale (Part 1)

Welcome to the ultimate revision guide for **Chapter 9: The Winter's Tale (Part 1)**, designed specifically for Tunisian Secondary School Students preparing for the national Baccalaureate. This booklet compiles comprehensive course sheets, structured active recall questions, and custom exam evaluations with keys. Based on the Charles and Mary Lamb narrative from the official Skills for Life textbook, it offers premium quality, precise vocabulary mappings, complete grammar worksheets for 'So + Adjective + That', and exact phonetic analysis guaranteed to unlock maximum performance.

Part 1	The Exhaustive Course Theory — Deep literary, lexical, grammatical and phonetic reference notes.
Part 2	The Active Recall Repository — Exactly 40 top-tier flashcard questions and answers formatted to maximize memory retention.
Part 3	The Exam Evaluation Quiz — 10 diagnostic QCM and True/False questions with detailed keys and core revision matrices.

Official Platform: mathbacai.com

Target Audience: Year 4 Secondary Education (Arts & Science Sections)

PART 1: THE EXHAUSTIVE COURSE THEORY

1. Literary Plot Analysis & Summary

The Winter's Tale is one of William Shakespeare's late romance plays (often called tragicomedies), simplified in the 19th century by the famous sibling authors Charles and Mary Lamb. Their version preserves the poetic morality and tragic depth of the original text while using more accessible syntax. In Part 1, we study the breakdown of human bonds and the rise of destructive irrationality.

The Characters & Court Dynamics:

- **Leontes (King of Sicily):** Initially a loving husband and friend, he is suddenly seized with an irrational, uncontrollable jealousy toward his wife and old schoolmate.
- **Hermione (Queen of Sicily):** Beautiful, noble, and good. She obeys Leontes by persuading Polixenes to stay, only to be falsely accused of unfaithfulness and shamefully cast into prison.
- **Polixenes (King of Bohemia):** Leontes' childhood companion and schoolfellow, who escapes Sicily to avoid being poisoned.
- **Camillo (Lord of the Sicilian Court):** A highly honorable man who refuses to obey Leontes' murderous command, instead choosing to warn Polixenes and escape with him to Bohemia.
- **Mamillius (Prince of Sicily):** The young, sensitive son of Leontes and Hermione. Out of pure grief and shock at his mother's public trial and imprisonment, he loses his appetite and dies of sadness.

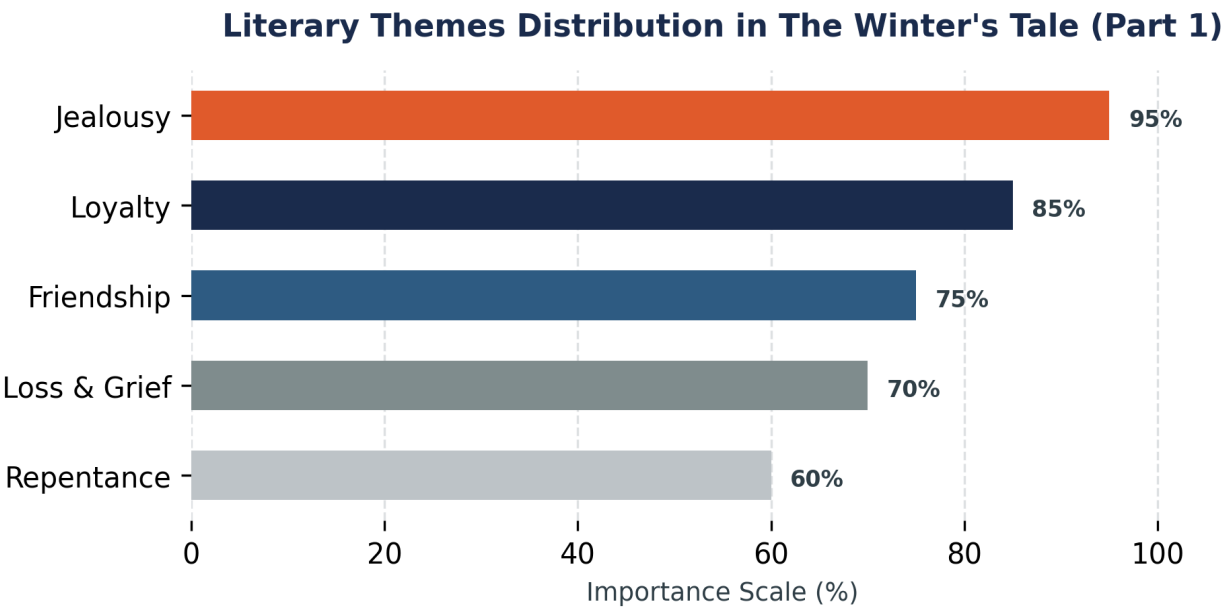


Figure 1.1: Visualizing the weight of central literary themes in Part 1. Note how Jealousy and Loyalty represent the major dramatic tension.

2. Lexical Portfolio (BAC Core Vocabulary)

This vocabulary table contains the most tested lexical items in the Tunisian Baccalaureate. Familiarize yourself with their contextual definitions and grammatical categories.

Word / Exponent	Baccalaureate Definition & Synonyms	Exam Example Context
To Rule (verb)	To govern, direct, or exert supreme authority over a kingdom, state, or nation.	Each king had to return to <u>rule</u> his own kingdom after their fathers' deaths.
To Beg (verb)	To ask for something in an anxious, intense, or deeply pleading manner; to implore.	Leontes <u>begged</u> the queen to give his companion her special care.
Evil (adjective)	Morally corrupt, cruel, wicked, or harmful; acting with malicious intent.	The king turned from a true friend into a wild and <u>evil</u> creature.
Send for (someone) (phrasal verb)	To officially summon or request someone's immediate presence or arrival.	Leontes immediately <u>sent for</u> Camillo to instruct him to poison Polixenes.
Unfaithfulness (noun)	The act of being disloyal or cheating on one's spouse; infidelity; betrayal of trust.	Leontes was consumed by false suspicions of his queen's <u>unfaithfulness</u> .
Shamefully (adverb)	In a disgracefully cruel, embarrassing, or utterly disrespectful manner.	The young prince became ill after seeing his mother treated so <u>shamefully</u> .

3. Advanced Grammar: Cause and Consequence (So + Adjective + That)

To express how an extreme state or quality (cause) results in a specific outcome (consequence), we use the syntactic structure:

[Subject] + Verb + SO + [Adjective] + THAT + [Clause of Consequence]

Exam Rules and Guidelines:

- 1. **Adjective Placement:** The adjective must sit strictly between so and that. Do not place nouns in this specific slot (e.g., use such a + noun + that for nouns).
- 2. **Consequence Nature:** The that clause must express an actual, completed result, not just a purpose (unlike so that, which expresses goal/purpose).
- 3. **Punctuation:** Never use commas to separate the cause and the consequence in this structure.

Grammar Demonstration and Exercise Modeling:

Example 1 (Character Cause-Effect):

- Leontes was jealous. He put his queen in prison.
- Leontes was **so jealous that** he put his queen in prison.

Example 2 (Action Cause-Effect):

- The little prince was sad. He completely stopped eating.
- The little prince was **so sad that** he completely stopped eating.

4. Phonetics Module: Stress Patterns & Silent Letters

In the national exam, phonetics exercises often target word stress placement and the identification of silent letters. This lesson focuses on the vocabulary of theatrical narratives and Shakespearean tragedies.

Phonetic Category	Standard Transcription & Exam Keys
1st Syllable Stress (Primary stress on onset)	• character /'kærəktə/ • narrative /'nærətɪv/ • jealousy /'dʒələsi/ • temple /'templ/
2nd Syllable Stress (Primary stress on second)	• unfaithfulness /ʌn'feɪθfəlnəs/ • companion /kəm'pæniən/ • suspicion /sə'spɪʃən/ • unhappy /ʌn'hæpi/
Silent Letters Identification (Graphemes with no sound)	• knight /naɪt/ → silent 'k' • castle /'kɑːsl/ → silent 't' • write /raɪt/ → silent 'w' • doubt /daʊt/ → silent 'b' • hasten /'heɪsn/ → silent 't'

PART 2: THE ACTIVE RECALL REPOSITORY

This repository contains exactly 40 premium flashcard-style questions and model answers, specifically designed to help you prepare for the oral and written sections of the Baccalaureate. Test your memory actively by covering the right-hand column.

Section A: Comprehension, Characters & Vocabulary (Q1 - Q20)

No. & Active Question	Detailed Model Answer / Grammar Key
Q1: Who is Leontes, and what is his status in the play?	Leontes is the King of Sicily. He is a primary character whose tragic flaw of irrational jealousy drives the plot of the story.
Q2: What is the relationship between Leontes and Polixenes?	They are childhood companions, schoolfellows, and close friends who were brought up together but separated as adults to rule their respective kingdoms.
Q3: Who is Hermione, and how is she described in Part 1?	Hermione is the beautiful and good Queen of Sicily, described as an excellent, honest, and loving wife who is deeply devoted to Leontes.
Q4: Why does Polixenes visit Sicily, and what happens when he tries to leave?	He came to visit Leontes after many invitations. When he prepares to leave, Hermione successfully persuades him to extend his stay at her husband's request.
Q5: What triggers Leontes' sudden, uncontrollable jealousy?	The fact that Hermione's gentle words successfully persuade Polixenes to stay after Polixenes had refused Leontes' own invitations.
Q6: Who does Leontes turn to for help in killing Polixenes?	He sends for Camillo, an honorable lord of his court, and orders him to poison Polixenes.
Q7: Why does Camillo refuse to poison Polixenes?	Camillo is a highly moral man who knows Hermione is completely innocent and that Leontes' suspicions are entirely baseless.
Q8: How does Polixenes escape Sicily safely?	Camillo warns Polixenes of the king's murderous orders and helps him escape from Sicily, accompanying him back to Bohemia.
Q9: What are the immediate consequences of Polixenes' escape?	Leontes becomes extremely angry, removes young Prince Mamillius from his mother's care, and throws Hermione into prison.
Q10: How does Leontes seek divine confirmation of his suspicions?	He commands two Sicilian lords, Cleomenes and Dion, to travel to Delphos and ask the oracle of Apollo at the temple.
Q11: What happens to Prince Mamillius in his mother's absence?	He becomes deeply unhappy, loses his desire to eat and sleep, and falls dangerously ill out of pure sadness.
Q12: What occurs shortly after Hermione is sent to prison?	She gives birth to a beautiful baby daughter, who serves as her only comfort in her dark prison cell.
Q13: What does Leontes' reaction to the baby show?	It shows his complete loss of reason; he refuses to believe the baby is his and acts like a wild, cruel creature.
Q14: Define the verb 'to rule' in a Bac context.	To govern, command, or hold supreme executive and political authority over a territory or kingdom.

No. & Active Question	Detailed Model Answer / Grammar Key
Q15: Provide a synonym for the verb 'to beg'.	To plead, implore, beseech, or entreat in a highly emotional, urgent manner.
Q16: What is the meaning and antonym of 'evil'?	Evil means wicked, cruel, or corrupt. Its direct antonyms are good, noble, virtuous, or righteous.
Q17: Explain the phrasal verb 'to send for' with an example.	It means to officially request or summon someone to come to you. Example: 'The king immediately sent for his chief advisor.'
Q18: Define 'unfaithfulness' and give its adjective form.	It means infidelity or betrayal of marital vows. The adjective form is 'unfaithful' (disloyal).
Q19: What does the adverb 'shamefully' express in the text?	It expresses deep disgrace, extreme cruelty, and a total lack of respect. Example: 'Hermione was treated shamefully.'
Q20: What genre does 'The Winter's Tale' belong to?	It is a narrative literary text, specifically a simplified dramatic romance (tragicomedy) designed to offer moral lessons.

Section B: Grammar Patterns, Prefixation & Stress Shifts (Q21 - Q40)

No. & Active Question	Detailed Model Answer / Grammar Key
Q21: What are the four essential features of a narrative text?	The four core features are: 1) Setting (time/place), 2) Theme (core message), 3) Plot (sequence of events/conflict), and 4) Characters.
Q22: How is cause and consequence expressed with 'so...that'?	Using 'Subject + Verb + SO + Adjective + THAT + Consequence Clause'. It stresses how a high degree of quality causes a specific result.
Q23: Combine: 'Hermione was noble. Everyone loved her.'	Hermione was <u>so noble that</u> everyone loved her.
Q24: Combine: 'Leontes was furious. He lost his sanity.'	Leontes was <u>so furious that</u> he lost his sanity.
Q25: What is the difference between 'so...that' and 'so that'?	'So...that' expresses cause and consequence (result), whereas 'so that' expresses purpose or goal.
Q26: Is 'so...that' followed by a noun or an adjective?	It is strictly followed by an adjective. For nouns, we use 'such a + noun + that' instead.
Q27: Correct: 'Leontes was so a jealous king that he put her in prison.'	Correction: 'Leontes was <u>so jealous that</u> he put her in prison' OR 'Leontes was <u>such a jealous king that</u> ...'
Q28: Identify the cause and result: 'Mamillius was so sad that he died.'	Cause: Mamillius' extreme sadness. Result/Consequence: His sudden tragic death.
Q29: Where does the primary stress lie in 'jealousy'?	On the 1st syllable: JEAL -ous-y (/ˈdʒeləsi/).
Q30: Where does the primary stress lie in 'unfaithfulness'?	On the 2nd syllable (the root): un- FAITH -ful-ness (/ʌnˈfeɪθfələnəs/).
Q31: Identify the silent letter in 'knight'.	The letter ' k ' is silent (/naɪt/).
Q32: Identify the silent letter in 'castle'.	The letter ' t ' is silent (/ˈkɑːsl/).
Q33: Identify the silent letter in 'write'.	The letter ' w ' is silent (/raɪt/).
Q34: Identify the silent letter in 'doubt'.	The letter ' b ' is silent (/daʊt/).
Q35: What are Charles and Mary Lamb known for?	They are famous 19th-century British authors known for simplifying Shakespeare's complex plays into moral, readable tales for youth.

No. & Active Question	Detailed Model Answer / Grammar Key
Q36: Why did Leontes suspect Hermione?	He suspected her because of his own internal mental illness of uncontrollable jealousy; she had done nothing wrong.
Q37: Where does the primary stress lie in 'companion'?	On the 2nd syllable: com- PA -nion (/kəm'pæniən/).
Q38: Where does the primary stress lie in 'narrative'?	On the 1st syllable: NAR -ra-tive (/ˈnærətɪv/).
Q39: What is the moral of Part 1 of the story?	The moral is that irrational jealousy destroys happiness, poisons sacred friendships, and ruins innocent family lives.
Q40: What is the role of Camillo in this story?	Camillo represents absolute moral integrity, loyalty to truth, and the refusal to obey evil orders.

PART 3: EXAM EVALUATION QUIZ & REVISION MEMOS

1. Diagnostic Assessment (10 Exam Questions)

Take this mock exam under real conditions. Answer all questions before checking the corrections on the next page.

PART A: Multiple Choice Questions (Grammar & Vocabulary)

Q1. Choose the correct grammatical combination:

- a) Leontes was so a jealous king that he put her in prison.
- b) Leontes was so jealous that he put her in prison.
- c) Leontes was jealous so that he put her in prison.

Q2. What does the word 'beg' mean when Hermione pleads with Polixenes?

- a) To ask for money in public.
- b) To command someone strictly.
- c) To plead or ask in an intense, anxious manner.

Q3. Identify the word with a silent letter:

- a) companion
- b) castle
- c) suspicion

Q4. Choose the word that bears the main stress on the SECOND syllable:

- a) jealousy
- b) companion
- c) character

Q5. Complete: 'Leontes and Polixenes had been brought ____ together.'

- a) down
- b) up
- c) out

PART B: True or False Statements (With Required Textual Justification)

Q6. True or False: Polixenes remained in Sicily and was successfully poisoned by Camillo.

Justification: _____

Q7. True or False: Prince Mamillius was unbothered by his mother's sudden imprisonment.

Justification: _____

Q8. True or False: The grammatical structure 'so...that' is used to express purpose.

Justification: _____

Q9. True or False: The letter 'k' in the word 'knight' is silent.

Justification: _____

Q10. True or False: Charles and Mary Lamb altered Shakespeare's plot to create a completely different story.

Justification: _____

2. Ultra-Detailed Correction Key

Review these explanations carefully to understand the exact scoring criteria used by Bacculaureate examiners.

Question	Detailed Correction, Grammatical Rule & Bac Key
Q1 Key: b	Option b is correct because 'so' must be followed directly by the adjective 'jealous'. Option 'a' is incorrect because 'so' cannot be followed by an article-noun phrase (we would need 'such a...'). Option 'c' is incorrect because 'so that' expresses purpose, which is semantically wrong here.
Q2 Key: c	In this classical literary context, 'to beg' means to plead anxiously. It does not relate to street begging for money, nor does it mean to command.
Q3 Key: b	In the word 'castle' /'kɑːsl/, the letter ' t ' is completely silent. In 'companion' and 'suspicion', all written letters are pronounced.
Q4 Key: b	The word 'com- PA -nion' is stressed on the 2nd syllable (/kəm'pæniən/). 'Jealousy' (JEAL -ous-y) and 'character' (CHA -rac-ter) are both stressed on the 1st syllable.
Q5 Key: b	The correct phrasal verb is 'to be brought up' (past participle of bring up), which means to be raised and educated during childhood.
Q6 Key: FALSE	Polixenes escaped Sicily safely with the assistance of Camillo, who warned him. Textual proof: 'instead of poisoning Polixenes, he told him of his master's orders and agreed to escape with him.'
Q7 Key: FALSE	Mamillius was deeply affected and fell mortally ill. Textual proof: 'When he saw her treated so shamefully... he became very unhappy. Gradually, he lost his desire to eat and sleep until it was thought his sadness would kill him.'
Q8 Key: FALSE	The structure 'so + adjective + that' expresses cause and consequence (result) , not purpose. Purpose is expressed using 'so that + modal' or 'in order to'.
Q9 Key: TRUE	The letter ' k ' in 'knight' (/naɪt/) is a silent onset consonant, representing a classic silent grapheme in English phonology.
Q10 Key: FALSE	They did not change the plot; they simplified the language and kept as close as possible to the original words. Textual proof: 'Charles and Mary Lamb tried to keep very close to the original words of the play.'

3. Excellence Revision Memos (Summary Tables)

Use these visual summary cards for quick revision before entering the exam room.

Memo Table 1.1: Syntactic Options for Cause & Effect

Structure Form	Grammatical Rules & Syntax	Model Example for Writing
So + Adjective + That	Expresses consequence. Followed by a complete clause with subject + verb.	The prince was <u>so sad that</u> he stopped eating.
Such + a + Noun + That	Used instead of 'so' when the cause is expressed as a singular countable noun phrase.	Leontes was <u>such a jealous king that</u> he ruined his family.
Too + Adjective + To	Expresses a negative consequence (meaning something is impossible).	The prince was <u>too unhappy to</u> recover from his grief.

Memo Table 1.2: Phonetics & Word Stress Rules

Phonological Pattern	Rule & Identification Strategy	Key Vocabulary Examples
1st Syllable Stress	Most 3-syllable nouns and adjectives in this chapter are stressed on the first syllable.	tem -ple, jea -lou-sy, cha -rac-ter, nar -ra-tive
2nd Syllable Stress	Verbs and words with prefixes or specific suffixes often shift stress to the second syllable.	com- pa -nion, sus- pi -cion, un- hap -py, de- par -ture
Silent Consonants	Historical spelling remains while the pronunciation was simplified over centuries.	cast le (silent t), kn igh t (silent k), doub t (silent b)